



Little Duck Plushie

A round, squashy duckling in fluffy chenille, worked as a single piece from tail to crown — no body-to-head seam; only the wings and the beak are sewn on

Design Code NS 05

Embroidered eyes

Confident beginner

1.5-2 hours

Stitch counts verified

About 16 cm (6.25 in) tall and 7.5 cm (3 in) wide in super-bulky chenille (#6) on a 4.5 mm hook • one seamless body; 2 wings + 1 beak to sew

Super-bulky chenille yellow ~25-35 g • orange for the beak • black floss • 4.5 mm hook • embroidered eyes, no plastic parts

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SAFETY — EMBROIDERED EYES

This duck uses EMBROIDERED eyes, which avoids the small-parts hazard of safety eyes — a real advantage if you sell finished toys.

If you sell them as toys, EU items need CE marking under EN 71 and US items must meet CPSIA and ASTM F963; independent testing is the only way to confirm.

Check seams hold under a firm pull and that the chenille pile does not shed, and tag each piece with materials, your maker name and an age recommendation.

Materials

- **Body yarn:** super-bulky chenille (#6), yellow, about 25–35 g. A 100 g ball makes two ducks comfortably. Fluffy chenille is the whole look.
- **Details:** a small amount of orange yarn for the beak; black yarn or embroidery floss for the eyes.
- **Hook:** 4.5 mm (US 7).
- **Stuffing & notions:** fibre fill about 25–35 g packed firmly; yarn needle, stitch marker, pins.

Gauge & size check

About 8 mm per stitch and 7 mm per round in super-bulky chenille.

Chenille varies between brands, so measure a 12-stitch swatch (about 10 cm) first. Finished size about 16 cm tall and 7.5 cm wide — 23 rounds at 7 mm and a widest point of 30 stitches at 8 mm.

Abbreviations — US terms

MR magic ring • ch chain • sc single crochet • inc increase (2 sc in one st) • dec invisible decrease • sl st slip stitch • FLO front loops only • FO fasten off • (n) stitch count.

Construction at a glance

- **Seamless.** the waist at R10-R12 and the reflare at R13-R14 separate body from head with no seam. Body and head are the same diameter (30 stitches, about 76 mm); the 18-stitch waist reads as the neck.
- **Start stuffing at R10.** once the waist closes you cannot reach the body.

The techniques that make this pattern

- **1. Magic ring & spiral** — the start of the body and each wing is a magic ring. Work in a continuous spiral — no join, no chain 1 between rounds — with a marker in the first stitch of every round.
- **2. Invisible decrease** — insert the hook under the FRONT loop only of the next two stitches, yarn over and pull through the first two loops (three loops on the hook), then yarn over and pull through both remaining loops. A flatter join than a standard decrease — it shows at this scale.
- **3. Around a chain (the beak)** — work around both sides of a starting chain: along one side, corner increases into the end chain, then back along the other side. Rnd 1 of a 5-chain totals 11 stitches; all five chains are used.
- **4. Through both layers** — to close each flat wing, fold it and single-crochet across both layers at once — 6 sc take the 12 stitches down to 6 and leave a flat half-disc.
- **5. Embroidery & sewing** — the eyes are embroidered (no safety eyes). The wings and the flattened, unstuffed beak are sewn on; sew through a whole stitch so they cannot pull out.

Making a smaller duck

Yarn	Finished height
Velvet / bulky (#5) · 3.0 mm hook	10 – 12 cm
Aran / worsted (#4)	9 – 10 cm
DK / light worsted (#3)	7.5 – 8.5 cm

1 • Body — tail to crown in one piece

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	
2	inc in each st around	12	
3	[sc, inc] x 6	18	
4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	24	
5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	30	body full width
6	sc in each st around	30	wings attach R6-R9
7	sc in each st around	30	
8	sc in each st around	30	
9	sc in each st around	30	
10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	24	START STUFFING NOW
11	sc in each st around	24	
12	[2 sc, dec] x 6	18	waist closing
13	[2 sc, inc] x 6	24	
14	[3 sc, inc] x 6	30	head begins
15	sc in each st around	30	
16	sc in each st around	30	eyes at R16-R17
17	sc in each st around	30	
18	sc in each st around	30	beak across R16-R18
19	sc in each st around	30	
20	[3 sc, dec] x 6	24	
21	[2 sc, dec] x 6	18	stuff head, shape cheeks
22	[sc, dec] x 6	12	add final stuffing
23	dec x 6	6	close via FLO

Fasten off with a long tail; thread through the FLO of the 6 remaining stitches, pull tight, knot and bury.

Smaller head option: skip the R14 reflare (keep R14-R19 at 24) and close R20 [2 sc, dec] x6 (18), R21 [sc, dec] x6 (12), R22 dec x6 (6).

2 · Wings — make 2

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Notes
1	6 sc in MR	6	
2	inc in each st around	12	
3	sc in each st around	12	
4	6 sc across both layers	6	flatten, close

Do not stuff. Flatten and sc 6 across both layers to close (12 sts to 6), leaving a flat half-disc about 30 mm across. Sew to the sides spanning R6–R9, angled slightly back.

3 • Beak — make 1 (worked around a chain)

Ch 5. Rnd 1: from the 2nd ch, sc in next 3, 3 sc in the last ch, rotate, sc in next 3, 2 sc in the last loop (11).
Rnd 2: inc, 2 sc, inc, 2 sc, inc, 2 sc, inc, sc (15). Sl st and fasten off with a long tail. Do NOT stuff — flatten it to a flat lens.

As written it is a bold ~50 mm cartoon beak; for a daintier duck work Rnd 1 only (11 sts, about 37 mm).

4 • Face & 5 • assembly order

- **1 Stuff from R10:** fill the body firmly as the waist begins to close — the neck narrows fast.
- **2 Eyes:** embroider black eyes between R16 and R17, about 7–8 stitches apart (56–64 mm on the 76 mm head), before the head closes.
- **3 Beak:** pin horizontally across R16–R18, centred between the eyes, and sew around the outer edge.
- **4 Wings:** sew one to each side at R6–R9, angled slightly back.
- **5 Close:** top up stuffing through R22, then close via the FLO and bury the end.

For your Etsy listing

- **Seller advantage:** embroidered eyes mean no small plastic parts — safer to sell, and no washers to work around.
- **Tag each toy:** materials, maker name, age recommendation.

Care

Surface clean with a damp cloth and mild soap; do not machine wash — chenille mats and sheds in agitation. Dry flat away from heat, and fluff the pile with a clean pet slicker brush once dry.

Colorways

- Classic yellow
- White duckling
- Pastel pink
- Aqua

Troubleshooting

- **Much taller than 16 cm.** your chenille is thicker than gauge. A 12-stitch swatch at 10 mm/stitch finishes near 20 cm.
- **Much shorter.** finer yarn — see the size table; DK on 3.0 mm gives 7–8 cm, not 10–12.
- **Wings sit on the neck.** too high. R6–R9 is the body; R10–R12 is the waist.
- **Beak leaves a gap / puffs.** each side must use four chains (no chain left over). Do not stuff; flatten before pinning.
- **Stuffing shows / head flops.** hook too large for the yarn, or the waist was under-packed. Pack R10–R12 firmly before the reflare.
- **Cannot reach the body to stuff.** you started too late — begin at R10 while the waist is still 24 stitches wide.

Why this pattern works — validation summary

Every stitch count in this pattern was checked with deterministic math (Crochet Pattern Checker): round-by-round production vs. consumption, stated counts, and every size claim against the stated gauge.

Check	Result
Body Rnds 1–23: 6 → 30 → 18 → 30 → 6 chain, stated counts match	✓ verified
Waist & reflare: [3 sc, dec]x6 = 24, [2 sc, dec]x6 = 18, [2 sc, inc]x6 = 24	✓ verified
Wings: 12 sts closed by 6 sc through both layers	✓ verified
Beak around a 5-ch: Rnd 1 = 11, Rnd 2 = 15	✓ verified
Height 23 rnds x 7 mm = 161 mm ~ 16 cm; width 30 sts ≈ 76 mm	✓ verified
Eye gap 7–8 sts = 56–64 mm on the 76 mm head	✓ verified
Smaller-head option: 24 → 18 → 12 → 6	✓ verified

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SAFETY REMINDER

Eyes are embroidered (no small plastic parts). Finished toys sold for children must still meet local toy-safety laws (EN 71 / CE in the EU; CPSIA and ASTM F963 in the US) — independent testing confirms compliance. Secure every seam and check the chenille does not shed.

Happy crocheting! Tag your makes with #NovalityStore and #LittleDuckPlushie — thank you for supporting an independent pattern designer.

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